LESSON 4

Ode to Joy

Beethoven's Ninth Symphony, first played in Vienna in 1824. The words here are our own.
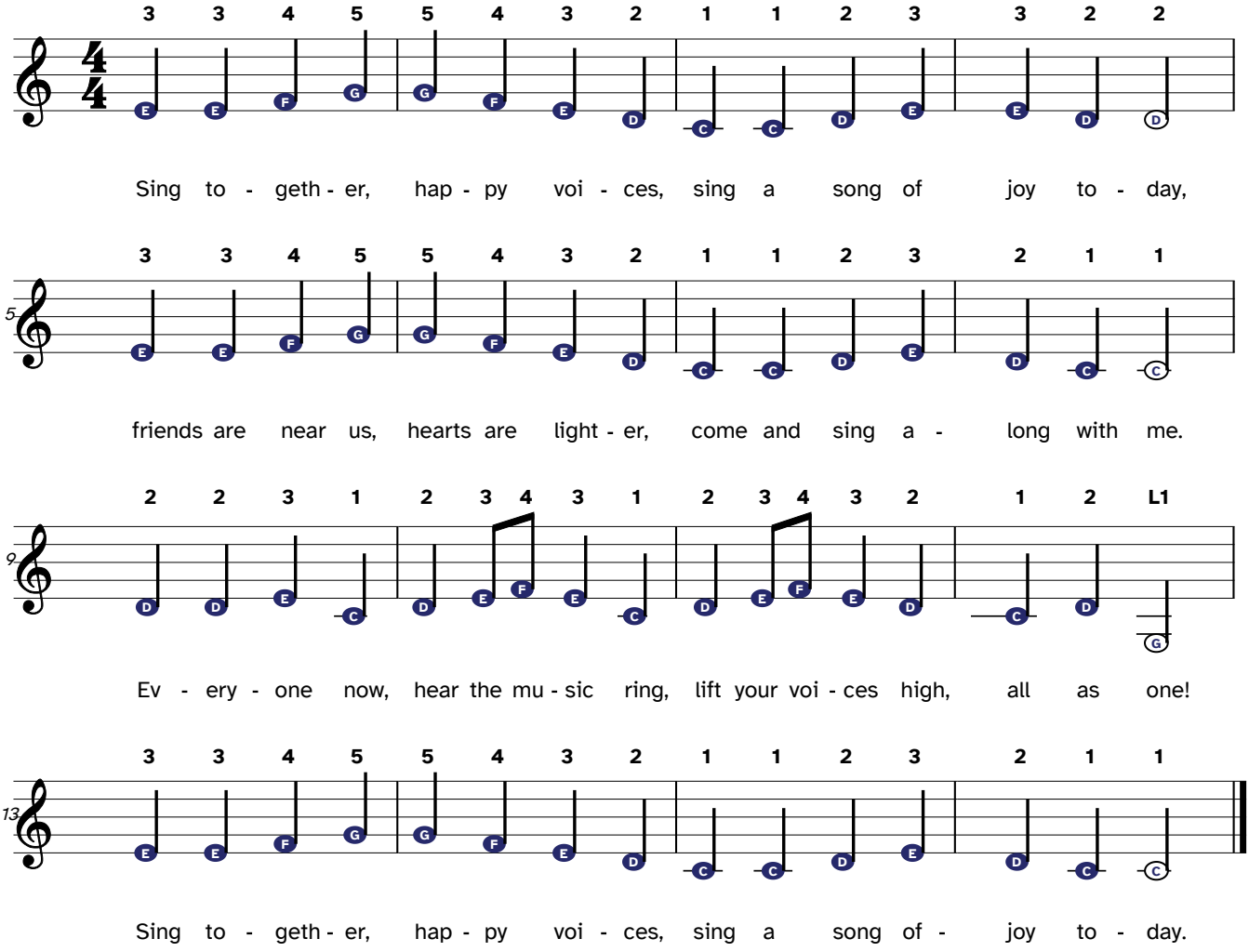
IN THIS SONG **the staff** **the Queen's sign** **all five fingers** **16 bars**

LISTEN FIRST

Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

1 Meet the song

Five lines and the Queen's sign, whose curl wraps round line 2: G. Listen, point, then sing.



THE WOW MOMENT

☆ **The composer never heard it.** Beethoven was deaf at the first concert; he had to be turned round to see the crowd clapping. Play it loud and proud, for him. Passport: Beethoven.

☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Sang it with the words** ☐ **Sang the letter names**

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE TIME

4/4

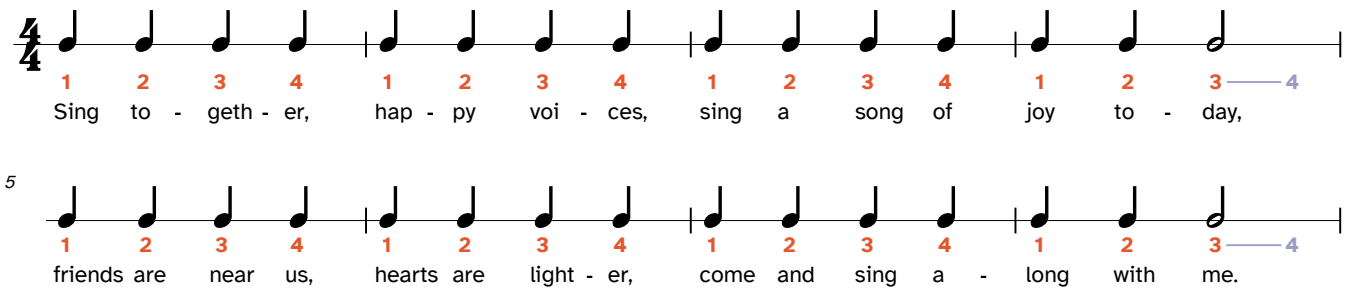
Top 4: four beats in every bar.
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

crotchet: walk
1 beat

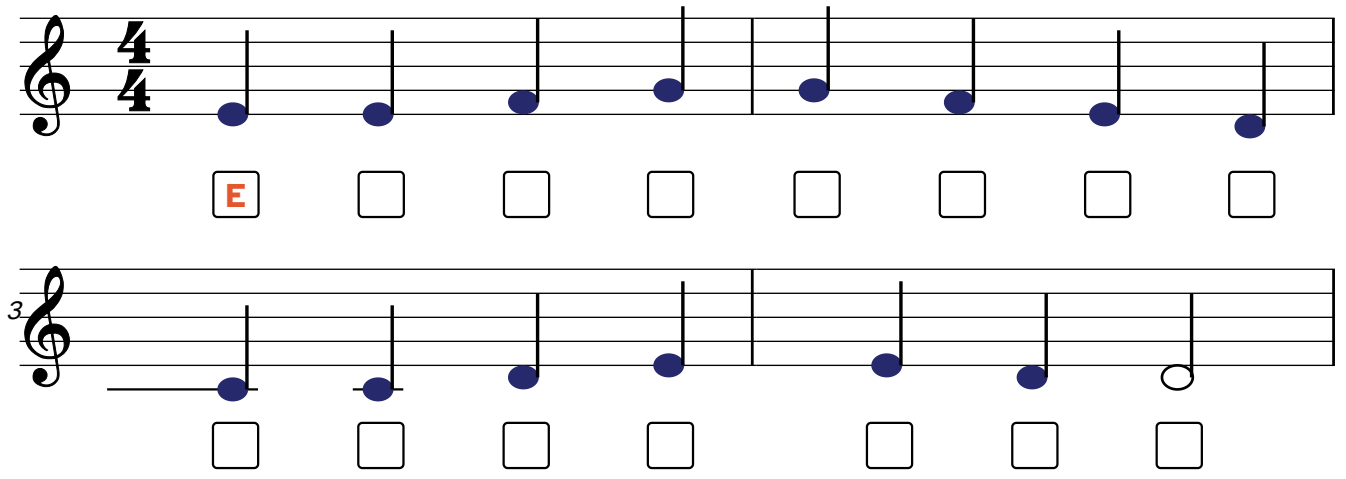
two quavers: run-ning
1 beat

minim: hold
2 beats



THE NOTES

Write the letter name under each note of the first four bars. E sits on the bottom line, G on line 2.

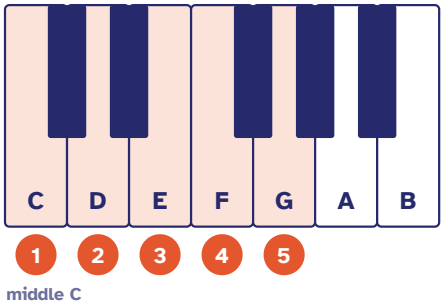


SPOT THE MISTAKE Your teacher plays the song with one wrong note. Put up your hand when you hear it, then find it on the page.

- [ ] **Said it in time**
- [ ] **Clapped and counted**
- [ ] **Wrote the letter names**
- [ ] **Spotted the mistake**

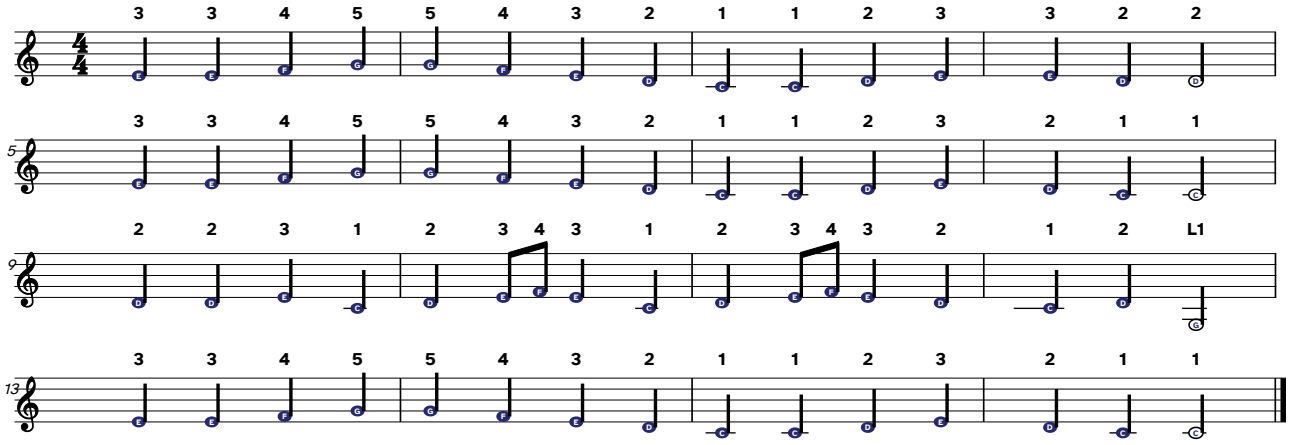
3 Play it

The right hand plays it all; the left hand plays lines 1 and 2, an octave lower.

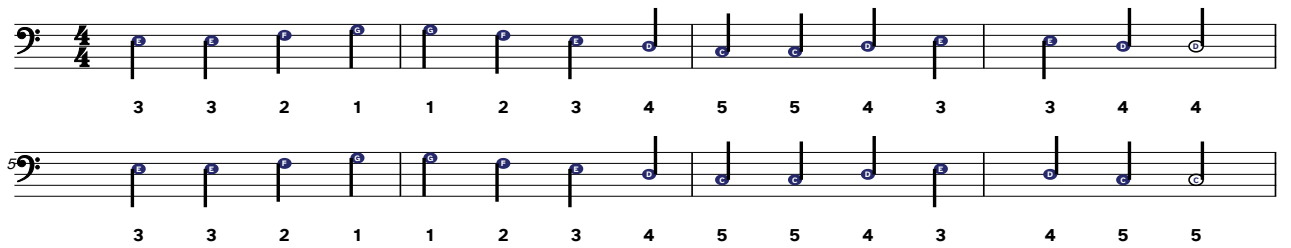


Right hand: thumb on middle C, 1 2 3 4 5 up to G. **Left hand:** an octave lower, on the King's staff: his sign's two dots wrap round F. Thumb on G, down to 5 on C. In line 3 the left thumb plays the low G for the right hand.

R RIGHT HAND the whole song



L LEFT HAND lines 1–2, the King's staff, an octave lower



4 · CHECK

☐ I can say and clap it ☐ I can sing it with the words ☐ I can find E and G on the s

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	With letters	No letters	With the band	Fast
Right hand				
Left hand				

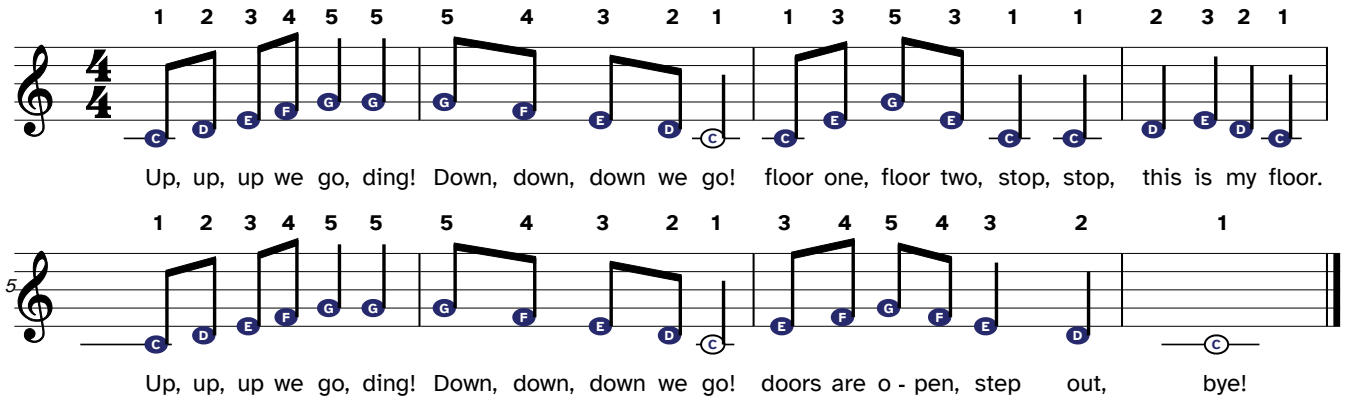
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

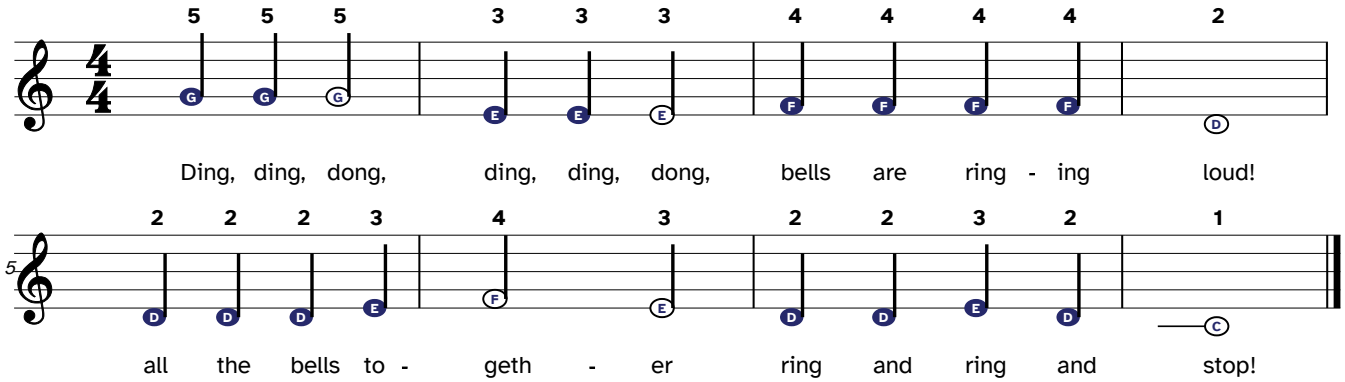
THE LIFT

A lift ride, quick and cheerful: all five fingers run up to G and back down, then hop between floors.



RING THE BELLS

Bright and ringing, a peek at Lesson 5: the same note again and again, then long notes to hold.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Can your teacher guess which?

- ☐ **Loud and proud, like a whole orchestra**
- ☐ **New house: thumb on G, the same fingers, the same song**
- ☐ **Soft and slow, like a prayer**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Right hand, lines 1 and 2
3. Right hand, the whole song
4. Play it with the orchestra

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played The Lift** ☐ **Played Ring the Bells**